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The Legends Ink
MONTHLY

KASHMIR SAFFRON
AND THE REST OF THE WORLD

A Precious Heritage, a Global Identity and a Future We Must Protect

The Legends Ink

Ink that speaks the truth.

The Legends Ink

INK THAT SPEAKS THE TRUTH.

Monthly Magazine

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Real Issues.
Real Change.

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All Disputes Shall be Subject to The Jurisdiction of Srinagar Courts Only

Editorial

Beyond Promises: Kashmir Deserves Accountability, Not Excuses

Every passing month brings fresh announcements, political debates and promises of a better tomorrow. Yet, for the people of Jammu and Kashmir, real progress must be measured through better education, reliable healthcare, employment opportunities and transparent governance.

As November begins, an important question deserves attention: Are promises translating into meaningful change on the ground?

Education and Employment

Government schools need adequate staff, proper infrastructure and competent leadership to ensure quality education for every child. Similarly, educated youth deserve transparent recruitment, fair opportunities and practical support for entrepreneurship. Degrees must open doors to employment rather than leave young people waiting indefinitely for opportunities.

Accountability in Governance

Public office is a responsibility, not a privilege beyond scrutiny. Development projects must be completed within reasonable timelines, public money spent transparently, and citizens' grievances addressed promptly. Allegations of corruption must be investigated impartially, regardless of position or influence.

Society and Journalism

Society must also confront challenges such as drug abuse, discrimination, educational inequality and violence against women. These problems demand collective action, effective law enforcement, rehabilitation and active community participation.

Journalism has an equally important responsibility to question authority, highlight genuine achievements and expose failures supported by evidence. At The Legends Ink Monthly, we believe public interest must remain at the centre of every serious discussion.

Kashmir possesses immense human potential, but progress requires responsible leadership, strong institutions and informed citizens.

The message is simple: our people deserve dignity, opportunity and justice—not another season of unfulfilled promises.

A better Kashmir will emerge through honest work, accountable governance and institutions that deliver what they promise.

— Editor

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The Indian Constitution: The Foundation of Justice, Equality and National Progress

An informed citizen is the strength of a democratic nation

POLITICAL DESK THE LEGENDS INK

The Constitution of India is one of the most important documents in the history of our country. It provides the framework for governance, defines the responsibilities of constitutional institutions, and protects the rights and freedoms of citizens. More than a legal document, it represents the aspirations of a nation committed to justice, liberty, equality and fraternity.

Adopted by the Constituent Assembly on 26 November 1949, the Constitution came into effect on 26 January 1950. Since then, it has served as the guiding light for India's democratic journey, helping the country manage its diversity through a common constitutional framework.

Understanding Our Fundamental Rights

The Constitution guarantees several Fundamental Rights that are essential for the dignity and development of individuals. Article 14 provides for equality before the law and equal protection of the laws. Article 19 protects certain freedoms, including freedom of speech and expression, subject to constitutionally permitted reasonable restrictions. Article 21 safeguards life and personal liberty, while Article 32 provides a constitutional remedy for the enforcement of Fundamental Rights.

These provisions remind us that every citizen deserves fairness, dignity and protection under the law. They also underline the importance of institutions that work impartially and uphold constitutional principles.

Duties Go Hand in Hand with Rights

A successful democracy depends not only on the rights enjoyed by its citizens but also on the responsibilities they

fulfil. Article 51A outlines the Fundamental Duties of citizens, including respecting the Constitution, cherishing the ideals of the freedom struggle, promoting harmony, protecting the environment and developing a scientific temper.

Responsible citizenship begins with everyday actions: obeying the law, respecting others, keeping public places clean, protecting public property and contributing positively to society. When citizens act with honesty and consideration, they strengthen the foundations of national unity.

Constitutional Institutions and Good Governance

The Constitution establishes the framework for Parliament, the President, the Council of Ministers, the judiciary and state institutions. It sets out their powers, functions and responsibilities to ensure that public affairs are conducted according to law.

Articles relating to Parliament, the Supreme Court and state governance illustrate the importance of institutional responsibility. The judiciary plays a vital role in interpreting the Constitution and protecting legal rights, while elected representatives and public officials have a responsibility to serve the people transparently and efficiently.

Good governance is most meaningful when public services reach ordinary citizens, educational opportunities improve, healthcare becomes accessible and development benefits communities across regions.

The Role of Education and Constitutional Awareness

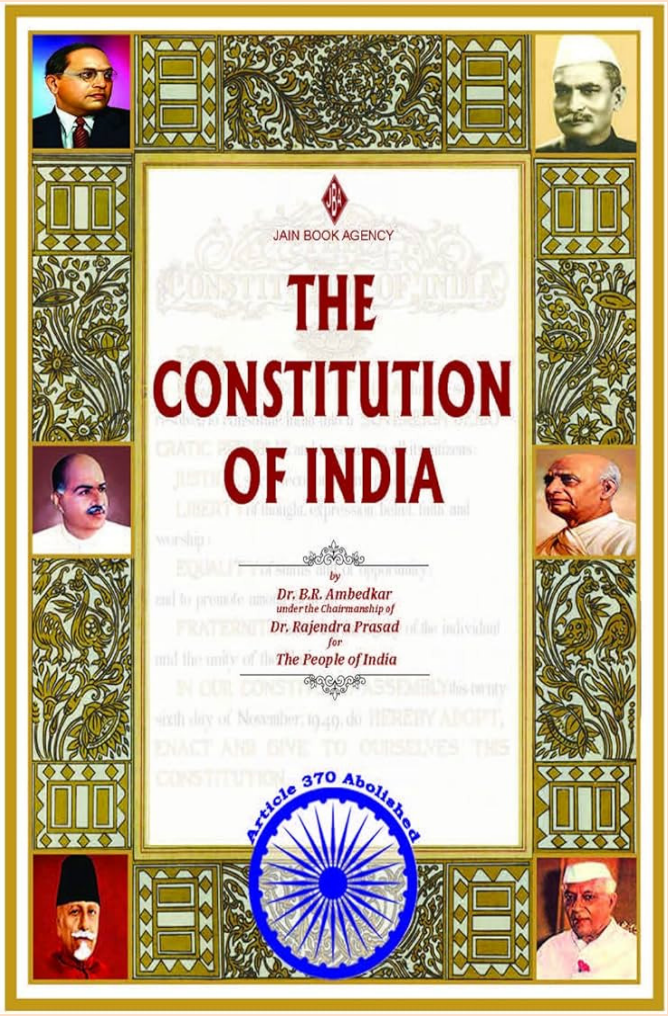
Constitutional awareness should not remain limited to law students, civil-service aspirants or legal professionals. Every student, teacher, parent and public servant can benefit from understanding the basic principles of the Constitution.

Schools, colleges, libraries and public institutions can organise discussions, debates and awareness programmes to explain constitutional values in simple language. Such initiatives can help young people understand the importance of democratic participation, mutual respect and peaceful resolution of differences.

For students preparing for competitive examinations, knowledge of constitutional Articles is particularly valuable. However, its significance extends far beyond examinations: it helps individuals become informed, responsible and confident citizens.

A Shared Responsibility for the Future

India's strength lies in its people, its cultural diversity



and its constitutional commitment to democratic governance. Protecting this legacy requires continuous learning, respect for lawful institutions and a collective commitment to public welfare.

The Constitution belongs to every citizen. Understanding it enables us to appreciate our rights, fulfil our duties and participate constructively in the nation's progress.

As India continues its journey towards greater prosperity and social development, constitutional literacy can serve as a bridge between citizens and institutions. The more deeply its principles are understood and practised, the stronger the foundations of democracy become.

Conclusion: The Constitution is not merely a collection of Articles and provisions; it is a living framework that guides the nation's democratic life. Respecting its values, understanding its principles and practising responsible citizenship are essential steps towards a more just, educated, peaceful and progressive India.

— The Legends Ink Monthly
"Ink that speaks the truth"

The World At A Crossroads

War, Rising Prices and the Search for Peace

THE LEGENDS INK EDITORIAL DESK

The world stands at a critical moment. While scientific discoveries, digital technology and artificial intelligence are transforming human life, international conflicts and economic uncertainty continue to threaten the security and prosperity of millions.

The consequences of war do not stop at national borders. Rising energy costs, disrupted trade, inflation and growing pressure on public finances can affect families thousands of kilometres away from the battlefield. For ordinary people, the international crisis is often felt through expensive fuel, costly food, fewer employment opportunities and an uncertain future.

The Human Cost of Conflict

Behind every headline about war are human lives. Children lose access to education, families are displaced, hospitals struggle to provide care, and communities face the difficult task of rebuilding their lives.

International leaders must remember that protecting civilians is not a political favour; it is a fundamental humanitarian responsibility. Humanitarian assistance must reach people in need, and international law must be respected.

An Economy Under Pressure

The International Monetary Fund's October 2026 outlook points to continuing risks from geopolitical tensions, high oil prices and economic uncertainty. Although artificial intelligence investment is supporting growth in some economies, its benefits are not distributed equally across the world.

Developing countries face particular challenges when energy and food become more expensive. Governments must protect vulnerable households while investing in education, healthcare, employment and sustainable development.

Can Diplomacy Make a Difference?

Military strength alone cannot guarantee lasting peace. Meaningful dialogue, respect for sovereignty, international cooperation and a willingness to negotiate remain essential to resolving disputes.

The United Nations and regional institutions have important roles to play in encouraging diplomacy and protecting vulnerable populations. Their success, however, depends on the willingness of member states to translate commitments into action.

A Responsibility to Future Generations

The international community must also confront climate change, poverty, inequality and the ethical challenges of artificial intelligence. These issues cannot be solved by one nation acting alone.

Countries must share knowledge, strengthen public institutions and ensure that technological progress creates opportunities for young people rather than widening existing divisions.

Conclusion: Humanity Must Come First

The measure of a nation's greatness should not be limited to its military power or economic wealth. It should also include the dignity it affords its citizens, the peace it promotes and the support it extends to people in need.

The world has the resources, knowledge and institutions to build a safer future. What is required is responsible leadership and the political courage to place human welfare above narrow interests.

Peace is not merely the absence of war. It is the presence of justice, dignity, opportunity and hope.

The Legends Ink — Ink that speaks the truth.

Kashmir's Silent Fracture: The Rising Tide of Divorce and the Lives Left Behind

THE LEGENDS INK EDITORIAL DESK

In the quiet lanes of Srinagar and the villages of the Valley, a shift is underway that few openly discuss. Marriages that once formed the bedrock of Kashmiri society are dissolving at a pace that would have been unthinkable a generation ago. What was once spoken of only in hushed tones has become a visible, everyday reality in family courts and community conversations.

A Sharp Rise in Broken Bonds

Courtrooms in Srinagar now handle three to five divorce petitions every working day. Similar patterns appear

in Baramulla, Pulwama, Anantnag and Budgam. Lawyers and court staff report that the number of formal petitions has multiplied by 300–400 per cent in urban centres compared with the early 2000s, when many courts recorded barely 50–60 cases a year. More than 60 per cent of these petitions are filed by women, many of them young and married for fewer than five years.

Official historical figures remain low by national and global standards—the 2011 census recorded a divorce rate of just 0.34 per cent in the former state. Yet the gap between official statistics and lived reality is wide. In rural areas, many separations never reach a courtroom; they are settled quietly by elders, clerics or simply by couples living apart under the same roof. "Grey divorce"—the quiet unravelling of long marriages among couples over fifty—is also becoming more common, though rarely formalised.

Domestic violence cases have risen sharply in the same period, with some reports indicating more than a doubling in a single year. The numbers point to a deeper social strain rather than isolated personal failures.

Why Marriages Are Breaking

The causes are layered and interconnected.

Domestic violence and emotional neglect sit at the centre of many petitions. Physical abuse, constant humiliation, and the refusal of families to treat a daughter-in-law with dignity remain frequent triggers. Interference by in-laws over finances, household roles and reproductive decisions continues to widen rifts that might otherwise heal.

Economic pressure adds another heavy weight. Extravagant weddings costing 20–40 lakh have become common, often financed through debt. When unemployment or underemployment follows, resentment grows quickly. Financial stress is rarely the sole reason for divorce, but it amplifies every other conflict.

Changing expectations play a powerful role. Young Kashmiris are more educated, marry later, and enter relationships with clearer ideas of personal autonomy and emotional fulfilment. The traditional call to "adjust and compromise at all costs" no longer carries the same force, especially among women who now have greater awareness of their legal rights. The shift from large joint families to nuclear households has removed the buffering presence of elders who once mediated disputes.

Social media has introduced new forms of mistrust. Online interactions, real or imagined, frequently fuel suspicion and accusations of infidelity. Drug abuse among sections of the youth has also entered the list of marital stressors. Infertility, once endured in silence, is now more openly cited as a reason for separation.

None of these factors operates in isolation. Together they reveal a society in transition—caught between traditional values that once held marriages together and modern realities that make endurance harder.

The Human Cost

For those who leave a marriage, the legal decree is only the beginning. In Kashmir, divorce remains heavily stigmatised. A woman is often labelled "the divorced one," her prospects for remarriage sharply reduced. Families fear social judgement; many pressure daughters to stay even in abusive homes. Men, too, face quiet suffering—loss of access to children, workplace stigma, and the emotional toll of prolonged litigation. False or exaggerated cases under laws meant to protect women have left some men feeling that the system assumes guilt first.

Children pay a particularly high price. They grow up in homes marked by silence, tension or abrupt separation. The absence of adequate counselling services and shelter homes leaves many families without support during the most vulnerable period.

Looking Ahead

There are no simple solutions, but several practical steps can reduce the damage. Pre-marital counselling that addresses expectations, finances and communication could help couples enter marriage with clearer eyes. Families need to lower the financial extravagance of weddings and treat daughters-in-law as members of the household rather than outsiders. Religious leaders and community elders who already handle informal separations can play a constructive role by encouraging reconciliation where possible and dignified exits where necessary.

The rise in divorce is not merely a moral failure. It is a symptom of deeper changes—economic insecurity, evolving gender roles, the erosion of traditional support systems, and the growing refusal of a younger generation to accept lifelong unhappiness. Acknowledging the problem honestly, without panic or denial, is the first step toward building healthier relationships and more resilient families in Kashmir.

The Valley has long prided itself on the strength of its social fabric. That fabric is fraying in places. Whether it is mended or continues to unravel will depend on how honestly and compassionately the community chooses to face the fracture.

Jantar Mantar and CJP: When The Streets Demand Answers

Democracy, Dissent and the People's Right to Be Heard

THE EDITORIAL DESK | THE LEGENDS INK

Democracy is not measured only by the number of elections held, the speeches delivered by political leaders, or the promises made from public platforms. Its real strength is reflected in how a nation listens to its citizens when they raise uncomfortable questions. Jantar Mantar in New Delhi has long represented this democratic tradition—a place where ordinary citizens, students, farmers, workers and social activists have gathered to demand accountability and justice.

The recent protests associated with the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) have once again brought the relationship between citizens, government institutions and the right to

peaceful assembly into public debate.

From a digital movement to the streets

CJP emerged as a youth-led online movement and subsequently organised demonstrations at Jantar Mantar. Its name attracted attention following a controversial courtroom remark by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant comparing certain young people to cockroaches. The movement's emergence reflected the ability of social media to turn public frustration into organised civic action.

Earlier demonstrations in June 2026 focused on alleged irregularities in competitive examinations and demands for the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. In October, the movement and allied groups mobilised around demands concerning Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. These demands and the allegations behind them require examination through evidence and the appropriate constitutional processes. They should not automatically be treated as established wrongdoing.

Jantar Mantar: A space for democratic dissent

Jantar Mantar is more than a location on Delhi's map. It has become a recognised symbol of public protest, from the anti-corruption movement led by Anna Hazare in 2011 to demonstrations by farmers, students and wrestlers.

Its significance lies in a simple democratic principle: citizens must have a peaceful way to communicate their grievances to those in power.

However, reports published on October 10, 2026, described heavy security, barricades and detentions that prevented demonstrators from reaching the planned protest site. Some groups subsequently held smaller demon-

strations at other locations across Delhi.

Such developments raise a fundamental question: how can public order be protected without making peaceful dissent ineffective?

The police have a legitimate responsibility to prevent violence, protect public property and maintain safety. Yet restrictions must have a lawful basis and remain proportionate to the actual risks. A peaceful assembly should not be treated as a threat merely because its message is critical of those in authority.

The Constitution and the right to protest

Article 19(1)(a) of the Indian Constitution protects freedom of speech and expression, while Article 19(1)(b) protects the right to assemble peacefully and without arms. These rights are subject to reasonable constitutional restrictions.

The right to protest does not mean that every gathering must be permitted at every location or without regulation. Equally, the power to regulate gatherings should not become an unrestricted power to silence criticism.

The Supreme Court's 2018 ruling concerning protests at Jantar Mantar and the Boat Club area rejected a blanket prohibition while allowing reasonable regulation of demonstrations.

The principle remains important: public safety and democratic freedom must be balanced through law, evidence and accountability—not through arbitrary decisions.

Elections and public confidence

The controversy surrounding CJP's demands concerning the Chief Election Commissioner and electoral-roll revision touches on an issue central to representative government: public confidence in elections.

Electoral rolls must be accurate, inclusive and transparent. Eligible voters should not lose their opportunity to participate because of administrative errors or inadequate grievance-redressal mechanisms. At the same time, claims of deliberate manipulation must be investigated on the basis of verifiable evidence rather than political accusation alone.

The Election Commission, political parties and civil society all have responsibilities in protecting the credibility of the electoral process. Clear explanations, accessible correction procedures and timely responses to documented complaints can help reduce mistrust.

When serious allegations arise, the appropriate response is transparent scrutiny, not simply a contest of competing slogans.

Youth anger deserves a serious response

Young Indians face concerns about employment, competitive examinations, educational opportunities and the fairness of public institutions. When these concerns accumulate, frustration can move from online platforms into public spaces.

Authorities should recognise that peaceful protest can provide an early warning of problems requiring attention. Ignoring legitimate grievances may deepen mistrust, while constructive engagement can help restore confidence.

Young protesters, in turn, have a responsibility to remain peaceful, avoid spreading unverified claims and present their demands with evidence. Democratic participation becomes more effective when passion is accompanied by facts and respect for the rights of others.

The question before India

The events surrounding Jantar Mantar and CJP are not merely about one organisation or one demonstration. They raise broader questions about how a democracy manages disagreement.

Can citizens peacefully question powerful institutions? Can the police maintain order without unnecessarily restricting fundamental rights? Can public authorities respond to allegations with transparency? And can political leaders distinguish legitimate criticism from attempts to create disorder?

These questions deserve answers grounded in constitutional principles and verifiable facts.

Democracy does not require the government to agree with every protester. It requires the government to respect lawful dissent, explain its decisions and remain accountable to the public.

Jantar Mantar's significance will therefore depend not simply on whether crowds can gather there, but on whether citizens retain meaningful, peaceful and lawful opportunities to be heard.

For a democracy to remain healthy, neither authority nor protest should stand above the Constitution. The law must protect public order, but it must also protect the citizen's voice.

The Legends Ink Monthly concludes: The real test of democracy is not whether a government can manage a protest, but whether it can address the grievances that brought people into the streets in the first place.

Beyond Borders: Indian and Pakistani Tennis Stars Win ITF Junior Doubles Title

Amrit Vats and Muhammad Yahya demonstrate that talent, teamwork and sportsmanship can unite young people across borders.

THE LEGENDS INK SPORTS DESK

In a remarkable moment for international junior tennis, India's Amrit Vats and Pakistan's Muhammad Yahya have joined forces to win the boys' doubles title at the ITF World Tennis Tour Juniors J30 tournament in Djibouti. The pair defeated Thailand's David Avayou and Saudi Arabia's Ahmad Bahaa Sarouji in the final, winning 6–2, 6–4. Their achievement has attracted attention not only for its sporting significance but also for the powerful message of cooperation between young athletes from two neighbouring countries.

A Victory Built on Teamwork

Tennis demands concentration, discipline, mutual understanding and the ability to trust a partner under pressure. Vats and Yahya demonstrated these qualities on the court, combining their skills to overcome international opponents and secure the championship.

Their victory is a reminder that sporting excellence depends on dedication and teamwork rather than nationality. When the two players stepped onto the court as partners, their shared goal was clear: to compete with determination and win through their combined efforts.

When Sport Speaks Louder Than Politics

India and Pakistan have a complicated political history, and relations between the two countries have often been strained. Yet the success of these young tennis players offers a refreshing example of what can happen when people are given an opportunity to work together.

Sport cannot resolve every political disagreement, nor should an athletic victory be mistaken for a diplomatic breakthrough. But it can create moments of mutual respect, demonstrate the value of peaceful competition and remind people that ordinary human connections can cross national boundaries.

The achievement also recalls the celebrated Indo-Pak Express partnership of India's Rohan Bopanna and Pakistan's Aisam-ul-Haq Qureshi, who earned international recognition through their doubles performances and became symbols of sporting cooperation.

A Message for the Next Generation

For young people in India, Pakistan, Jammu and Kashmir and beyond, this victory carries a valuable lesson: rivalry need not become hostility, and differences need

not prevent cooperation. Young athletes deserve opportunities to train, compete and build friendships through international sporting platforms. Their success should inspire investment in sports facilities, coaching, fitness programmes and fair opportunities for talented children, regardless of their economic background.

The achievement of Vats and Yahya is therefore more than a trophy-winning moment. It is a celebration of discipline, shared ambition and the spirit of fair play.

The Legends Ink Perspective

The tennis court offers a simple but meaningful lesson for our wider society: people can pursue a common goal even when they come from different backgrounds.

Amrit Vats and Muhammad Yahya have shown that, when talent meets teamwork, borders do not have to become barriers to human cooperation. Their victory deserves recognition as a sporting achievement and as an encouraging example for the younger generation.

Sometimes, the most powerful message of peace is not delivered through a speech. It is demonstrated through two players standing together on a court, competing as one team.

KASHMIR SAFFRON
AND THE REST OF THE WORLD

A Precious Heritage, a Global Identity and a Future We Must Protect

THE LEGENDS INK MONTHLY

Introduction: The Red Gold of Kashmir

Kashmir is known across the world for its breathtaking landscapes, rich cultural heritage, traditional handicrafts and unique agricultural treasures. Among these, Kashmiri saffron holds a special place. Known as Kong Posh in Kashmiri, this delicate purple flower produces the precious red stigmas commonly called the world's red gold.

Cultivated particularly in the Pampore area of the Kashmir Valley, saffron is more than an agricultural commodity. It represents the hard work of generations of farmers, the traditional knowledge of local communities and the economic potential of Kashmir's fertile land.

But an important question remains: Has Kashmir received the full economic benefit and international recognition that its saffron deserves?

Kashmir's Saffron on the Global Stage

Saffron is used across the world in cooking, traditional preparations, cosmetics and the fragrance industry. Countries such as Iran, India, Afghanistan, Spain and Greece are associated with saffron production, while international markets demand high-quality saffron for its colour, aroma and flavour.

Kashmiri saffron has distinctive qualities, including its strong aroma, deep colour and traditional reputation for quality. Its Geographical Indication (GI) status provides a valuable identity linked to its region of origin. This recognition can help distinguish genuine Kashmir saffron from products sold under misleading or generic labels.

However, international reputation alone does not guarantee prosperity for local growers. Farmers need reliable markets, transparent prices, authentic certification and access to buyers who are willing to pay for genuine quality.

The Struggles Behind Every Saffron Flower

Behind every small quantity of saffron lies considerable human effort. Farmers must cultivate the land, protect the crop, harvest delicate flowers at the right time and carefully separate the red stigmas.

The delicate saffron flower, a symbol of purity and prosperity.

*Careful hands, careful harvest —
this is how the world's finest saffron is picked.*

Freshly harvested flowers, ready for the next step.

*The golden red threads —
worth more than gold.*

*Carefully dried and sorted —
ready for the global market.*

*From fields to kitchens —
saffron adds richness to every moment.*

*Authentic Kashmiri saffron —
pure, natural, priceless.*

Climate variability, irregular rainfall, rising production costs, pressure on agricultural land and changing market conditions can make saffron cultivation increasingly challenging. Competition from other producing countries also places pressure on prices and market share.

When production becomes uncertain and returns remain inadequate, younger generations may hesitate to continue this traditional occupation. Such a development would threaten not only farmers' livelihoods but also a valuable part of Kashmir's agricultural heritage.

From Pampore to the World: What Must Change?

If Kashmir wants its saffron to compete more effectively in international markets, it must move beyond the sale of raw produce and invest in a complete value chain.

First, farmers should receive better access to scientific cultivation techniques, soil testing, irrigation support and climate-resilient agricultural practices.

Second, stronger testing, traceability and anti-adulteration measures are essential. Consumers must be able to identify genuine Kashmiri saffron with confidence.

Third, farmer cooperatives and producer organisations should help growers negotiate better prices, reduce dependence on intermediaries and reach buyers directly.

Fourth, modern packaging, digital marketing, e-commerce and international trade partnerships can help local producers establish a stronger global presence.

Finally, research institutions, agricultural departments, exporters and private enterprises must work together to ensure that the greatest possible share of the value reaches the farmers who produce this precious crop.

The World Must Recognise the Farmer

A product becomes internationally successful when quality, trust and fair trade come together. Kashmir's saffron has a remarkable foundation, but the farmer must remain at the centre of its development.

Global buyers should demand authenticity, while consumers should be encouraged to purchase verified products rather than be guided by price alone. Policymakers must also ensure that the benefits of GI recognition, branding and export growth reach genuine cultivators.

Kashmir's saffron story should not be limited to beautiful flowers, attractive packaging or claims about its international reputation. It should also be a story about the income of farmers, the sustainability of cultivation and the protection of rural livelihoods.

Conclusion: Protect the Roots, Expand the Reach

Kashmir saffron has the potential to become an even stronger symbol of the Valley's agricultural excellence. But its future depends on more than tradition. It requires innovation, scientific support, genuine branding, fair prices and a sustained connection with international markets.

The world may admire the colour and fragrance of Kashmir's red gold, but the real measure of success will be whether the people who cultivate it can live with dignity and confidence.

Kashmir has given the world a precious gift. Now it is time to ensure that the world recognises its true value—and that the rewards reach the hands that grow it.

The Legends Ink Monthly — Ink that speaks the truth.

Mahatma Gandhi in World Literature: When the Pen Met the Power of Non-Violence

How Gandhi's life, philosophy and struggle travelled across borders and inspired writers, thinkers and movements for justice

Mahatma Gandhi was not merely a political leader of India. He became a subject of world literature, philosophy and intellectual debate—a figure whose life compelled writers, historians, poets and political thinkers across continents to reflect on truth, non-violence, freedom, human dignity and social justice.

The accompanying picture, "World Literature on Mahatma Gandhi," brings together a remarkable constellation of international writers and thinkers associated with Gandhi's intellectual legacy. From Romain Rolland and George Bernard Shaw to Pearl S. Buck, George Orwell, Arnold Toynbee, Martin Luther King Jr. and Albert Einstein, the image symbolises how Gandhi's ideas crossed geographical, cultural and political boundaries.

Gandhi: A Man Who Became a Global Idea

Gandhi's extraordinary influence came not simply from what he wrote, but from the way he attempted to live his principles. Satyagraha, his philosophy of holding firmly to truth through non-violent resistance, offered an alternative to the traditional idea that political power could be achieved only through force.

His life became a form of literature in itself.

His autobiography, The Story of My Experiments with Truth, transformed personal experience into a philosophical exploration of morality. Gandhi wrote openly about his successes, failures, doubts and experiments. This honesty gave his writings a universal quality: the struggle he described was not only the struggle of an Indian nationalist but the struggle of an individual attempting to discover how truth could be lived.

Romain Rolland and the European Intellectual World

French writer and Nobel laureate Romain Rolland played an important role in introducing Gandhi to European intellectual audiences. Rolland regarded Gandhi as a significant moral personality of the modern age and wrote about him at a time when the world was witnessing the devastation of war and political violence.

For European intellectuals living through the trauma of the First World War and its aftermath, Gandhi's insistence on non-violence presented a profound question:

Could moral courage become stronger than military power?

That question remains relevant even today.

George Bernard Shaw and the Power of Moral Leadership

The Irish-born playwright George Bernard Shaw belonged to a generation of thinkers deeply interested in social reform, political power and inequality. Gandhi's experiment offered another dimension to these debates—the possibility that political transformation could be pursued through mass mobilisation without making violence the foundation of the movement.

Gandhi demonstrated that a seemingly powerless population could challenge an enormous imperial system through discipline, civil resistance and collective moral pressure.

George Orwell: Admiration with Questions

The relationship between Gandhi and George Orwell is particularly interesting because Orwell did not approach Gandhi with unquestioning admiration. In his essay "Reflections on Gandhi," Orwell examined Gandhi's character and philosophy critically.

This is one of the strengths of Gandhi's place in world literature: he does not have to be presented as a flawless saint to remain historically important. Great literature often begins where simple admiration ends.

Orwell's examination reminds readers that Gandhi can be studied simultaneously as a political leader, moral philosopher and deeply complicated human being.

Pearl S. Buck and the Universal Appeal of Gandhi

American writer and Nobel laureate Pearl S. Buck was another prominent Western intellectual who recognised the significance of Gandhi and the Indian freedom struggle.

For writers outside India, Gandhi represented something larger than Indian nationalism. His struggle raised universal questions about colonialism, poverty, dignity and the rights of ordinary people.

His message travelled because it addressed conditions that were not confined to one country.

Martin Luther King Jr: Gandhi Across the Ocean

Perhaps one of the most powerful examples of Gandhi's influence can be seen in the American Civil Rights Movement.

Martin Luther King Jr. studied Gandhi's philosophy and adopted non-violent resistance as a central element of the struggle against racial segregation and discrimination in the United States.

The connection between Gandhi's India and King's America demonstrates the extraordinary journey of an idea.

Gandhi's struggle was directed against colonial rule; King's movement confronted racial injustice. Their circumstances were different, yet the underlying principle was similar:

An unjust system can be challenged without surrendering one's humanity to hatred.

This transformed non-violence from an Indian political strategy into a global language of civil rights.

Einstein and the Moral Question of the Modern Age

Albert Einstein also expressed profound respect for Gandhi. Einstein's interest in Gandhi reflected a broader intellectual concern of the twentieth century: humanity had acquired enormous scientific and technological power, but had it acquired equal moral wisdom?

That question became painfully relevant in an age of world wars and weapons of mass destruction.

Gandhi's answer was uncompromising: technological progress without moral progress could become dangerous.

Arnold Toynbee and the Civilisational Dimension

British historian Arnold J. Toynbee viewed Gandhi within the larger story of civilisation and the changing relationship between East and West.

Gandhi challenged the assumption that modernity had to be defined by industrial power, military strength and material accumulation. He placed ethical responsibility, community life and human dignity at the centre of his vision.

This remains one of the most interesting aspects of Gandhi's legacy.

Beyond Politics: Gandhi in Poetry, Biography and Philosophy

The influence represented in the picture extends beyond political writing. Gandhi entered poetry, biography, history, philosophy and journalism. Writers and intellectuals from different cultures interpreted him according to their own historical circumstances.

Brazilian poet Cecília Meireles, African political leaders such as Kwame Nkrumah, and thinkers from different parts of the world contributed to a growing international conversation about freedom, colonialism and human dignity.

The result is not a single "Gandhian literature" but a vast international conversation in which Gandhi becomes a reference point for discussing the fundamental questions of civilisation.

Why Gandhi Still Matters

More than seven decades after India's independence, Gandhi's ideas remain both influential and contested.

The world continues to struggle with war, political polarisation, inequality, religious intolerance, racism, environmental destruction and social injustice.

In such a world, Gandhi's questions remain uncomfortable but necessary:

Can freedom exist without responsibility?

Can justice be achieved without hatred?

Can political power remain ethical?

Can development take place without sacrificing human dignity?

These are not merely historical questions.

They belong to our present.

Brazilian poet Cecília Meireles, African political leaders such as Kwame Nkrumah, and thinkers from different parts of the world contributed to a growing international conversation about freedom, colonialism and human dignity

The Ink and the Spinning Wheel

The books depicted at the bottom of the picture—representing philosophy, biography, poetry, history, civil rights, humanism, non-violence, social justice, freedom and peace—capture the extraordinary breadth of Gandhi's intellectual legacy.

The spinning wheel became one of Gandhi's symbols. The pen became another.

One represented self-reliance and dignity of labour; the other represented ideas, reflection and the power of communication.

Together they tell a remarkable story: a man who challenged an empire without an army eventually became a subject of literature around the world.

Conclusion: A Legacy Still Being Written

Gandhi's story did not end with his assassination in 1948. It continued through books, essays, poems, universities, civil-rights movements and generations of readers. His admirers have seen him as a prophet of peace; his critics have questioned aspects of his philosophy and politics. Both responses have kept the intellectual conversation alive.

Perhaps that is the greatest tribute literature can give a historical figure—not to turn him into a statue, but to keep asking questions about him. Gandhi belongs to India by history, but to the world by influence.

And as long as writers continue to debate truth, freedom, non-violence, justice and the dignity of the human being, the story of Gandhi in world literature will remain unfinished.

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Young Talent, Big Dreams: Mohsin Reshi Makes His Mark in Cricket

A Class 6 Student of RJ's International School, Sumbal, Participates in a C11CL League Match in Jammu

THE LEGENDS INK MONTHLY

Sports are not merely about winning matches; they are about discipline, dedication, teamwork and the courage to pursue one's dreams. Young Mohsin Reshi, a Class 6 student of RJ's International School, Sumbal, is taking steps towards his cricketing aspirations after participating in a C11CL league match in Jammu.

Mohsin's participation in a competitive cricket league is an encouraging milestone for a young student who is balancing his education with an interest in sports. At an age when children are discovering their talents and building their ambitions, opportunities to participate in organised competitions can help develop confidence, sportsmanship and a stronger sense of responsibility.

Cricket: A Platform for Young Aspirations

Cricket enjoys immense popularity among the youth of Jammu and Kashmir. From local playgrounds to organised tournaments, the sport continues to inspire children to work hard, practise regularly and dream of representing their schools, districts and, one day, the country.

For young players like Mohsin, participation in league matches provides valuable exposure to competitive cricket. Such experiences can teach young cricketers how to handle pressure, cooperate with teammates, respect opponents and learn from every match.

Mohsin's journey also highlights the importance of encouraging sporting talent at the school level. Schools, parents, coaches and local sports organisations can play a significant role in identifying promising players and providing them with proper training, facilities and opportu-

nities.

Education and Sports Must Go Together

As a student of RJ's International School, Sumbal, Mohsin represents the importance of combining academic learning with extracurricular activities. Education builds knowledge and character, while sports help develop fitness, discipline, determination and leadership.

Young athletes should be encouraged to maintain a healthy balance between their studies and sporting commitments. With the right guidance, consistent practice and family support, a child's passion for cricket can become a valuable part of personal growth.

A Message of Encouragement

Mohsin Reshi's participation in a C11CL league match in Jammu is a moment worth recognising as he continues to explore his potential in cricket. His experience can inspire other young students in Sumbal and neighbouring areas to take an active interest in sports and work towards their goals.

The road to sporting success demands patience, hard work and perseverance. Every match offers a lesson, every practice session builds skills, and every opportunity helps a young player grow.

The Legends Ink Monthly wishes Mohsin Reshi success in his academic and sporting journey. May his enthusiasm for cricket continue to grow, and may he inspire more young talents from Kashmir to step forward and pursue their dreams.

"Great cricketers are not made in a day; they are shaped by discipline, determination and the courage to keep playing."

Kashmir's Dying Chinars: Who Will Save The Soul Of The Valley?

An Environmental Destruction, Public Accountability and the Future of Kashmir's Heritage

THE LEGENDS INK MONTHLY

There was a time when autumn in Kashmir was incomplete without the breathtaking sight of Chinar trees transforming the Valley into a landscape of gold, copper and crimson. Their majestic branches, spreading across gardens, roadsides, shrines and village squares, were not merely part of the scenery; they were a living symbol of Kashmir's identity, history and cultural pride.

Today, however, a troubling question confronts every environmentally conscious citizen: Are we protecting Kashmir's Chinars, or are we allowing our priceless natural heritage to disappear before our eyes?

The growing concern over the cutting, damage and declining condition of Chinar trees demands urgent public attention. Every mature Chinar lost to unnecessary construction, careless planning or administrative negligence

represents a loss that cannot simply be repaired by planting a few saplings elsewhere. A tree that has stood for centuries cannot be replaced in a single season.

A heritage under pressure

The Chinar is much more than a tree. It is a witness to Kashmir's changing history, a companion to generations of people and an inseparable feature of the Valley's cultural landscape. Its shade has offered comfort to travellers, its leaves have inspired poets and photographers, and its autumn colours have attracted visitors from across the country and beyond.

Yet development pressures, expanding settlements, road-widening projects, disease, ageing and shrinking green spaces are putting this heritage at risk.

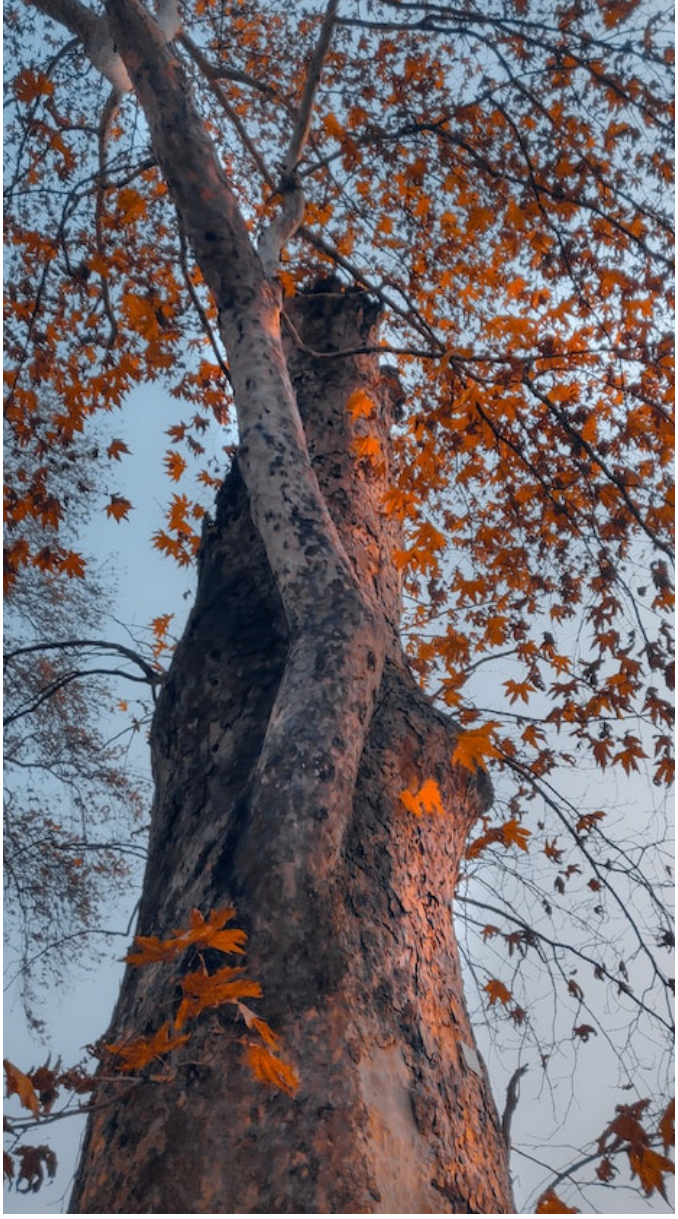
A report published in October 2026, referring to a scientific census conducted by the Forest Research Institute, Srinagar, stated that more than 30,000 Chinar trees had been identified in the Kashmir Valley, with additional trees within security establishments still awaiting inclusion in the count. The census also highlighted threats including ageing, pests and disease, tree cutting for development, and increasing pressure on land. These figures demonstrate the importance of systematic monitoring; they do not mean that all remaining Chinars are safe.

The central issue is not whether Kashmir needs roads, public facilities or modern infrastructure. It does. The real question is whether development must come at the cost of trees that have survived for generations. Progress that destroys irreplaceable heritage without seriously exploring alternatives is not responsible progress.

Road widening cannot become a licence to destroy

Recent public debate over road-widening work in Ganderbal has brought this issue into sharp focus. On October 15, 2026, Chief Minister Omar Abdullah spoke about mature Chinar trees obstructing road widening and the possibility of removing and replanting them elsewhere. The discussion has raised an important question about how infrastructure projects should balance public convenience with environmental preservation.

Authorities must recognise that transplanting a mature Chinar is not as simple as moving a roadside signpost. The survival of an old tree after transplantation is uncertain, and its ecological value cannot be recreated immediately. Any proposal to relocate a mature Chinar should therefore be supported by an independent arboricultural assessment, a clear explanation of why preservation in place is not feasible, and a publicly available plan for monitoring the tree's survival.



Before a healthy, heritage tree is marked for removal, every reasonable alternative should be examined. Can the road alignment be adjusted? Can the design be modified? Can engineering solutions protect the tree while meeting public needs?

These questions should be answered transparently, not after the tree has already been cut.

Accountability must replace excuses

The protection of Chinars cannot depend solely on public emotion, social-media campaigns or occasional statements from officials. It requires a clear, enforceable and transparent system of accountability.

Whenever a mature Chinar is felled, citizens deserve to know who authorised the action, what assessment was conducted, which alternatives were considered and whether the decision complied with the law. Where alle-

gations of unauthorised felling arise, the relevant department should investigate promptly and publish its findings.

The controversy surrounding Chinar trees at Rani Bagh in Anantnag in 2025 demonstrated how disputes can emerge over whether work described as pruning involved the removal of whole trees. Such cases underline the need for independent verification, clear records and public disclosure rather than conflicting claims.

The Forest Department, local administration, municipal authorities and agencies responsible for road construction must work together under a common conservation framework. Responsibility should not disappear into a maze of departments and contractors.

If a tree is illegally felled, the matter should be investigated and accountability established. If a tree must be removed for a genuinely unavoidable public purpose, the decision should be justified with evidence and accompanied by meaningful conservation measures.

A Chinar should not be sacrificed simply because protecting it requires additional planning, time or expense.

Planting saplings is not enough

Tree plantation drives are welcome, but they cannot become a convenient substitute for protecting mature trees. A young sapling and a centuries-old Chinar are not equivalent in shade, ecological function, historical value or visual character.

Kashmir needs a long-term Chinar conservation mission that goes beyond ceremonial plantation events. Every significant Chinar should be mapped, photographed, geo-tagged and assessed for its health. The digital identification initiative reported in recent years is a positive step, but its value will depend on regular updates, public access to reliable records and effective action when trees are threatened.

The government should publish an annual district-wise report covering the number of Chinars recorded, trees lost, trees damaged, permissions issued for removal, reasons for removal and the survival rate of transplanted trees. A publicly accessible register would help citizens, researchers and environmental organisations monitor progress.

Where removal is unavoidable, replacement planting should use suitable locations and species, with a multi-year survival programme. The priority, however, must remain the protection of existing mature Chinars.

A responsibility shared by society

The responsibility to save Kashmir's Chinars does not rest with the government alone. Citizens must also resist the careless cutting of trees, report suspected violations through lawful channels, support conservation campaigns and teach younger generations the value of their natural surroundings.

Journalists have a duty to investigate environmental concerns fairly and persistently. Civil society organisations can document threatened trees and demand transparent decisions. Educational institutions can make environmental awareness part of everyday learning. Experts can help authorities design infrastructure that respects the natural landscape.

Most importantly, conservation must not be reduced to a political slogan. The Chinar belongs to Kashmir's people, irrespective of political affiliation, district or community. Its protection should be a shared public commitment.

The future of Kashmir is rooted in its trees

Autumn will return every year, but the Valley will not look the same if its mature Chinars continue to disappear. Tourism may bring visitors, roads may shorten journeys, and buildings may expand, but none of these achievements can fully compensate for the loss of an irreplaceable natural landmark.

The government must act before the damage becomes irreversible. Conduct a comprehensive, independent audit of Chinar trees; make felling permissions public; investigate credible allegations of unauthorised removal; protect healthy heritage trees during construction; and hold responsible officials and contractors accountable where wrongdoing is established.

The people of Kashmir deserve development that respects both their present needs and their inheritance from the past.

Let us remember: a Chinar is not merely timber, an obstacle beside a road or a statistic in a departmental report. It is a living monument to Kashmir's history and a gift to future generations.

If we allow our Chinars to vanish, we will lose more than trees. We will lose a part of Kashmir's soul.

The time has come for action, transparency and a firm commitment to conservation. Let the protection of every remaining Chinar become a test of our collective responsibility.

Save the Chinar. Save Kashmir's heritage. Save the soul of the Valley.

Anne Carson: A Nobel Triumph That Redefines The World Of Literature

How a Canadian poet transformed classical traditions into a bold, modern literary language

PARVAIZ AHMED RESHI

The world of literature has a new reason to celebrate. Canadian poet, essayist, translator and classicist Anne Carson has been awarded the 2026 Nobel Prize in Literature, recognising a remarkable body of work that challenges conventional boundaries between poetry, prose, philosophy and the classical traditions of ancient Greece.

The Swedish Academy honoured Carson for her bold and inventive literary achievements, highlighting the way her engagement with classical traditions has helped create new forms of contemporary literature. Her achievement represents not merely an individual triumph, but also a celebration of intellectual curiosity, artistic courage and the enduring power of the written word.

A Voice Beyond Conventional Literature

Anne Carson has built an extraordinary literary reputation by refusing to be confined to a single genre. Her writing moves freely between poetry, essays, translation, drama and experimental forms. Ancient myths and philosophical questions often find new life in her work, where they interact with the complexities of modern existence.

Unlike conventional literary narratives, Carson's writing frequently invites readers to pause, question and interpret. Her works explore love, desire, memory, grief, identity and the fragile relationships between human beings. Through unusual structures and unexpected combinations of ideas, she demonstrates that literature can be both intellectually demanding and deeply emotional.

Her distinctive approach has earned her an international readership among those who believe that literature should not simply tell stories but also challenge the ways in which people understand the world.

Bringing the Ancient World into Modern Life

One of Carson's greatest contributions is her ability to connect classical literature with contemporary concerns. Her knowledge of ancient Greek language, literature and philosophy has provided a foundation for works that speak to readers far removed from the historical worlds that inspired them.

Her acclaimed book Autobiography of Red reimagines the ancient Greek myth of Geryon through a modern, unconventional narrative. The work demonstrates how mythology can be transformed into a powerful exploration of identity, relationships and emotional vulnerability.

In Eros the Bittersweet, Carson examines the nature of desire through classical literature and philosophy. Her work Nox, meanwhile, combines poetry, images, fragments and personal reflection to confront the experience of loss and the difficulty of preserving memories.

These works reveal an author who sees literature as an evolving conversation between the past and the present.

A Literary Journey Defined by Courage

Born in Toronto, Canada, Carson developed a deep interest in classical languages and literature. Her academic background helped shape a writing style distinguished by precision, experimentation and a willingness to question established literary conventions.

Over the years, she has received significant recognition for her contributions to literature, including the MacArthur Fellowship and major poetry awards. Her Nobel Prize now places her among the most celebrated literary figures of the modern era.

Yet Carson's significance extends beyond the list of awards she has received. Her career demonstrates that serious intellectual inquiry and artistic experimentation can coexist with emotional depth. She has shown that poetry need not follow predictable patterns to communicate powerful truths about human experience.

Why Her Nobel Prize Matters

Carson's recognition carries an important message for writers, students, educators and readers across the world: creativity thrives when people are willing to challenge familiar boundaries.

In an age dominated by rapid communication, instant opinions and the constant flow of digital information, her work reminds us of the importance of reflection, language and sustained intellectual engagement. Her writing asks readers to slow down, consider unfamiliar perspectives and recognise the complexity of human emotions.

For young writers in particular, Carson offers an example of how originality can emerge from a serious engagement with history, philosophy and the literary achievements of earlier generations. Her success demonstrates that innovation does not require abandoning tradition; sometimes, it means returning to tradition with fresh eyes.

A Message for the Literary World

Anne Carson's Nobel triumph is a powerful reminder that literature remains one of humanity's most enduring forms of expression. It crosses geographical boundaries, connects generations and gives language to experiences that are often difficult to explain.

Her achievement also reinforces the importance of protecting literary freedom and supporting writers who explore unfamiliar ideas. A vibrant literary culture must make room for experimentation, independent thought and voices that challenge established expectations.

For readers around the world, Carson's recognition is an invitation to discover the richness of her work and reconsider what poetry and literature can achieve.

Conclusion

The Nobel Prize in Literature is more than an honour bestowed upon an individual writer. It is a recognition of the transformative power of imagination, language and thought.

Anne Carson's achievement celebrates a literary vision that brings the ancient and the modern into conversation, turning familiar traditions into new possibilities. Her work

reminds us that literature is never merely a record of the world as it exists; it is also a means of questioning that world and imagining what it might become.

As the literary community celebrates her remarkable accomplishment, Carson's Nobel triumph stands as a testament to the enduring value of originality, intellectual courage and the written word.

The Legends Ink Monthly celebrates writers whose ideas, creativity and courage continue to shape the intellectual and cultural life of humanity.

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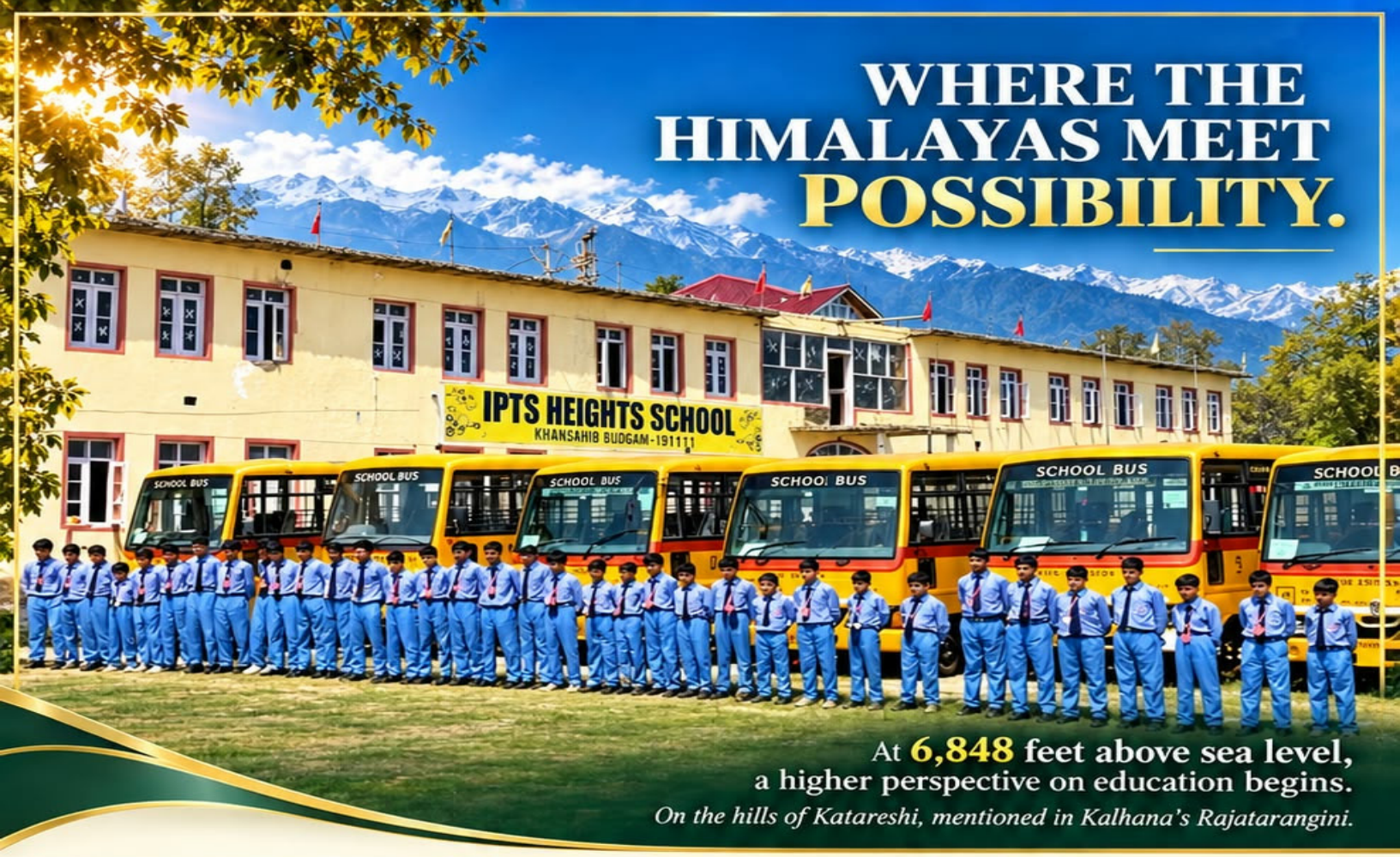

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